Trading Bot Guide for Beginners

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The bot is a signal bot: it watches markets and tells you BUY or SELL, and you place the trade yourself. Only have a phone? Do Part 1, then Part 3. Have a computer? Do Part 1, then Part 2.

Quick start: your two locked-in strategies

The bot runs the two strategies that held up in testing and alerts you when either says BUY or SELL.

List	Strategy	Coins	Where to edit
Main	200-day trend filter: hold while the price is above its 200-day average	Bitcoin, Ethereum, Solana, S&P 500 (SPY), Nasdaq (QQQ)	`watchlist.main.txt`
Meme coins	20-day breakout, $30 per coin: buy at a new 20-day high, sell at a 10-day low	19 Coinbase meme coins, plus any Fomo coin you add	`watchlist.memes.txt`

To start it: on Windows, double-click **START_ALERTS.bat** in the trading-bot folder. On a Mac, double-click **start_alerts.command** (the first time, right-click it, choose Open, then Open again). Leave the window open; close it to stop. Your alert channel, how often it checks and the $30 amount are saved in **alerts.yaml**.

You still need Python installed once (Part 2, Step 2) and the ntfy app on your phone (Part 1).

What the bot does and doesn't do

The bot never touches your money. It looks at prices, runs a strategy, and tells you IN (buy or keep holding) or OUT (sell or stay in cash).

What you want to watch	Can it give BUY/SELL signals?	How to type it
Stocks and funds (S&P 500, Nasdaq, Apple, Nvidia, Tesla)	Yes	`SPY`, `QQQ`, `AAPL`, `NVDA`, `TSLA`
Big crypto on Coinbase (Bitcoin, Ethereum, Solana, XRP)	Yes	`BTC-USD`, `ETH-USD`, `SOL-USD`, `XRP-USD`
Older meme coins on Coinbase (Dogecoin, Shiba Inu)	Yes	`DOGE-USD`, `SHIB-USD`
Brand-new pump.fun meme coins	No, they have no price history yet	Research only, with the launch watcher

The bot has two ready-made strategies:

- **Trend filter** (`config.trend.yaml`): checks once a day and trades 1 to 3 times a year. It tested best overall and mainly avoids big crashes.
- **Day trading** (`config.daytrade.yaml`): checks 15-minute candles and holds for a few hours. It tested weakly and only made sense with very low fees.

Nothing here is a promise. Every strategy lost money in some years.

Part 1: Get BUY/SELL alerts on your phone (5 minutes)

You'll use a free app called **ntfy**. It needs no account, no email and no password. Think of it as a private radio channel: the bot talks on it, your phone listens.

1. Open the **App Store** (iPhone) or **Google Play** (Android).
2. In the search bar at the top, type **ntfy** and tap Search.
3. Find the app with a white and green icon named **ntfy** and tap **Get** (iPhone) or **Install** (Android). Wait for it to finish.
4. Tap **Open**.
5. If your phone asks "Allow notifications?", tap **Allow**. This is what lets the alerts pop up on your lock screen.
6. Tap the **+** button. On iPhone it's at the top right; on Android it's the round button at the bottom right.
7. In the box called **Topic name**, type your private channel name exactly:

   - `tbot-00dcc1a84c`
   - Every letter and number matters. No spaces.
8. Leave every other setting as it is, and tap **Subscribe**.
9. You'll now see `tbot-00dcc1a84c` in your list. That's your alert inbox. It's empty until the bot sends something.

Keep the name secret. Anyone who types the same name into ntfy can see your alerts. They can't touch your money, but keep it private anyway.

Nothing arrives yet. The bot has to be running somewhere to send alerts. That's Part 2 (computer) or Part 3 (phone only).

Part 2: Run the bot on a computer (about 20 minutes, one time)

You only do steps 1 to 4 once. After that, starting the bot takes 30 seconds.

Step 1: Download the bot

1. On the computer, open a web browser (Chrome, Edge or Safari) and go to **claude.ai**. Sign in.
2. Open this same chat (the trading bot one).
3. Scroll to the most recent file card named **trading-bot.zip** and click it to download.
4. Open your **Downloads** folder (Windows: the folder icon on the taskbar, then Downloads; Mac: Finder, then Downloads).
5. Unzip it:
   - **Windows:** right-click **trading-bot.zip**, choose **Extract All**, then click **Extract**.
   - **Mac:** double-click **trading-bot.zip**.
6. You now have a folder called **trading-bot**. Drag it onto your **Desktop** so it's easy to find.

Step 2: Install Python (the language the bot is written in)

1. Go to **python.org/downloads** and click the big yellow **Download Python** button.
2. Open the file you just downloaded.
3. **Windows only, very important:** on the first screen, tick the box at the bottom that says **Add python.exe to PATH**. Then click **Install Now**.
4. **Mac:** click **Continue** through each screen, then **Install**, and type your Mac password if asked. When it finishes, a folder opens: double-click **Install Certificates.command** inside it.
5. Click **Close** when it says the setup was successful.

Step 3: Open a terminal inside the bot's folder

The terminal is a window where you type commands instead of clicking.

- **Windows:** open the **trading-bot** folder on your Desktop. Click once in the address bar at the top (where it shows the folder path), delete what's there, type `cmd` and press **Enter**. A black window opens.
- **Mac:** open **Terminal** (press Command + Space, type Terminal, press Enter). Type `cd` (c, d, then a space), drag the **trading-bot** folder from your Desktop into the Terminal window, and press **Enter**.

Step 4: Install the bot's parts (one time)

Type this and press **Enter** (on Mac, type `pip3` instead of `pip`):

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Text scrolls by for a minute. When it stops and you can type again, it's done.

Step 5: See the signals right now

Type this and press **Enter** (on Mac, type `python3` instead of `python` in every command):

```
python -m bot -c config.trend.yaml signals
```

After a few seconds you'll see a table. IN means buy or keep holding; OUT means sell or stay in cash. The last column tells you how far the price must move to flip the signal.

To choose your own markets, add `--markets` and a list with commas and no spaces:

```
python -m bot -c config.trend.yaml signals --markets BTC-USD,ETH-USD,DOGE-
USD,SPY,TSLA
```

Step 6: Test the phone alert

```
python -m bot signals --notify ntfy:tbot-00dcc1a84c --test-alert
```

Within a few seconds your phone should show "Test alert from your trading bot". If it does, alerts work.

Step 7: Leave it running so it alerts you

```
python -m bot -c config.trend.yaml signals --markets BTC-USD,ETH-USD,SOL-
USD,SPY --notify ntfy:tbot-00dcc1a84c --every 30
```

It checks every 30 minutes and only alerts when a signal changes. Leave the window open and the computer awake (turn off sleep in your power settings). To stop it, click the window and press **Ctrl + C**.

Next time: open a terminal in the folder (Step 3) and run Step 7. That's it.

Even easier: skip Steps 3 to 7 and double-click **START_ALERTS.bat** (Windows) or **start_alerts.command** (Mac). It installs what's needed and runs both strategies with your saved settings.

Part 3: Phone only? Let GitHub run it every hour for free

GitHub is a website that stores code. It can also run the bot for you on its own computers every hour, for free, and send the alerts to your phone. You never need a computer.

Step 1: Make a GitHub account

1. In your phone's browser (Safari or Chrome), go to **github.com/signup**.
2. Type your email, make a password only you know, and pick a username.
3. Solve the "are you human" puzzle, then type the code GitHub emails you.
4. If it says **"Too many requests"**: wait an hour, or switch from Wi-Fi to mobile data (or the other way round), then try again.

Step 2: Make an empty project (called a repository)

1. Tap the **+** at the top right, then **New repository**.
2. Under **Repository name**, type `trading-bot`.
3. Tap **Private** so only you can see it.
4. Don't tick any boxes below that. Scroll down and tap **Create repository**.

Step 3: Let Claude upload the bot for you

1. Go to **claude.ai/connect-github** and sign in to GitHub when asked.
2. When it asks which repositories Claude can use, choose **Only select repositories**, pick `trading-bot`, and tap **Install** or **Save**.
3. Come back to this chat and type **done**. Claude uploads everything.

Step 4: Tell GitHub where to send alerts

1. On github.com, open your `trading-bot` repository.

2. Switch your browser to the desktop website: Safari, tap **aA**, then **Request Desktop Website**; Chrome, tap ⋮, then tick **Desktop site**. The settings tab is hidden on the mobile layout.
3. Tap **Settings** (the gear icon in the row of tabs).
4. In the left menu, tap **Secrets and variables**, then **Actions**.
5. Tap the green **New repository secret** button.
6. **Name:** `ALERT_TARGET`
7. **Secret:** `ntfy:tbot-00dcc1a84c`
8. Tap **Add secret**.

Step 5: Nothing to choose

GitHub uses the same settings as your computer: **alerts.yaml**, **watchlist.main.txt** and **watchlist.memes.txt**. To add a coin, open the watchlist file on github.com, tap the pencil icon, add a line, and tap **Commit changes**. The ALERT_TARGET secret from Step 4 is optional; it only overrides the channel in alerts.yaml.

Step 6: Switch it on

1. Tap the **Actions** tab at the top of your repository.
2. If you see a green button that says **I understand my workflows, go ahead and enable them**, tap it.
3. In the left list, tap **signals**, then **Run workflow**, then the green **Run workflow** button.
4. After about a minute, a green tick means it worked. A red cross means something went wrong: send Claude a screenshot.

From now on it checks every hour, by itself. Your phone only buzzes when a signal changes, which for the trend filter is a few times a year per market.

Part 4: What to do when an alert arrives

An alert looks like this on your lock screen: 🟢 **BUY BTC-USD at $81,249.31** or 🔴 **SELL BTC-USD at $71,500.00**. The bot doesn't know what you own, so you decide and you press the button.

Before your first trade, decide two things and write them down:

- **How much per trade.** Pick a small, fixed amount, like $20, and use the same amount every time.

- **Which app.** Crypto: Coinbase (or Fomo). Stocks and funds like SPY: a stock broker app such as Robinhood, Fidelity or Schwab.

When you get a BUY in Coinbase

1. Open the **Coinbase** app.
2. Tap the **search** (magnifying glass) and type the coin's name, for example **Bitcoin**. Tap it.
3. Tap **Buy**.
4. Type your amount, for example **20**.
5. Check that **Pay with** shows your cash balance or bank card.
6. Tap **Preview buy**. Look at the **fee** line. If the fee is a big part of your amount, use a larger amount less often.
7. Tap **Buy now**. Done.

When you get a SELL in Coinbase

1. Open **Coinbase**, search for the coin and tap it.
2. Tap **Sell**.
3. Tap **Max** to sell everything you bought, or type an amount.
4. Tap **Preview sell**, check it, then tap **Sell now**. The money goes back to your Coinbase cash balance.

Fomo or any other app: it's the same idea. Find the coin, tap Buy for a BUY alert, and tap Sell for a SELL alert. The bot's alerts work with any app because you're the one tapping.

Starting fresh: when you first set up, some markets are already IN. You can either buy them now, or wait for the next BUY alert. Waiting is calmer and is what the tests did.

Day-trading alerts (if you chose `config.daytrade.yaml`): a BUY means sell the same day. Sell when the SELL alert comes, or before you go to bed, whichever is first.

Part 5: The easiest option, just ask Claude

In the Claude app, open the trading bot chat and type what you want in normal words. Claude runs the bot and explains the answer. It works on any phone, with nothing to install. For example:

- "check signals" for the latest BUY/SELL table
- "check signals for DOGE, SHIB and TSLA"
- "check the meme coins" for the launch watcher's results

- "backtest the trend filter on Ethereum"

The catch: Claude only checks when you ask. For alerts that come to you on their own, use Part 2 or Part 3.

Part 6: Meme coin alerts with $30 per coin, including Fomo coins

This uses the meme-coin breakout rule: BUY when a coin closes at its highest price in 20 days, SELL when it closes at its lowest in 10 days. It tested best of every meme-coin method we tried, but it still lost money in the 2025 to 2026 meme crash (about half what holding lost). Expect roughly one trade every two months per coin.

Your meme watchlist is a text file called `watchlist.memes.txt` in the trading-bot folder. It already lists the 19 meme coins Coinbase sells.

To add a coin from Fomo

1. In Fomo, open the coin's page.
2. Find its **contract address** (often shown as CA, or under the coin's name or a share or info button) and tap **copy**. It's a long code of letters and numbers.
3. Open `watchlist.memes.txt` (on a computer: right-click, Open with, Notepad or TextEdit; on GitHub: tap the file, then the pencil icon).
4. Add a new line at the bottom: `sol:` followed by the address with no space, for example `sol:DezXAZ8z7PnrnRJjz3wXBoRgixCa6xjnB7YaB1pPB263`. Use `base:` for Base coins and `bsc:` for BNB Chain coins.
5. Save the file.

Always use the address, never just the name: scammers make fake coins with famous names. The bot can't see Fomo's own lists, such as its trending page, only coins you add.

See the meme signals now (computer, in the trading-bot folder):

```
python -m bot -c config.memes.yaml signals --watchlist watchlist.memes.txt --
stake 30
```

Get meme alerts on your phone, saying "BUY $30 of …":

```
python -m bot -c config.memes.yaml signals --watchlist watchlist.memes.txt --
stake 30 --notify ntfy:tbot-00dcc1a84c --every 60
```

On GitHub (Part 3), there's nothing extra to set: the hourly runner checks both lists from alerts.yaml, including the $30 amount.

When a BUY comes: buy $30 of that coin, in Fomo or in Coinbase using Advanced trade (the simple Buy button can charge a flat fee of a few dollars on small orders). **When a SELL comes:** sell all of that coin. Never add more money to a coin that's falling.

Cheat sheet and fixes

Type these in the terminal, inside the trading-bot folder. On a Mac, use `python3` instead of `python`.

I want to	Type this
See trend signals now	`python -m bot -c config.trend.yaml signals`
See day-trading signals now	`python -m bot -c config.daytrade.yaml signals`
Watch my own list	add `--markets BTC-USD,DOGE-USD,SPY`
Test phone alerts	`python -m bot signals --notify ntfy:tbot-00dcc1a84c --test-alert`
Get alerts every 30 minutes	add `--notify ntfy:tbot-00dcc1a84c --every 30`
Stop the bot	click the window, press Ctrl + C
Test a strategy on past prices	`python -m bot -c config.trend.yaml backtest --data csv:data/btc_usd_1d.csv --start 2022-01-01`
Research new meme coins	`python -m bot launches watch --hours 2 --last 1h`, then `python -m bot launches report`

What you see	What it means and what to do
`'python' is not recognized` or `command not found`	Python isn't installed or wasn't added to PATH. On Mac, type `python3`. On Windows, reinstall Python and tick Add python.exe to PATH.

What you see	What it means and what to do
`No module named ...`	The parts aren't installed. Run `pip install -r requirements.txt` again, inside the trading-bot folder.
`could not check: ...` next to a market	That name wasn't found. Crypto needs `-USD` (like `DOGE-USD`); stocks are just the ticker (like `TSLA`).
The test alert says NOT delivered	Check the topic name for typos. If it says quota reached, wait until tomorrow or use another network.
No alerts for days	Normal. The trend filter only changes a few times a year. Use `--test-alert` to check the connection.

Safety rules

1. **Only use money you could lose completely** without it hurting your rent, bills or food.
2. **Same small amount every trade.** Don't double up to win back a loss.
3. **Signals are not promises.** In testing, the best strategy still had losing months and dropped about 50% at its worst.
4. **Never share passwords, seed phrases or private keys,** not with a bot, a website, a Telegram group or anyone in your DMs. The bot never asks for them.
5. **Meme coins are a lottery.** In our test of 1,300+ new coins, buying them all lost about 9% within an hour, and about 1 in 11 crashed to nearly zero.
6. **Practice first.** Watch the alerts for a few weeks without trading and see how they would have done before you use real money.